Matty Prior had been nagging Trotty to work on his fielding. His point, that the standards he set in county cricket were inadequate in the international arena, paid dividends on the fourth ball of the day. An inside edge on to Shane Watson's pads leaked into the leg side; he set off to run, hesitated, then bolted down the wicket.

Trotty took four paces to his right, swept up the ball on the run, steadied himself, and hit the stumps on the full, from just in front of square leg, with a right-arm throw. Simon Katich was well short, out without scoring, and Trotty was rewarded for hours of solitary practice. No wonder he ran around with his arm in the air as if he had scored the winner at Wembley. It remains one of his favourite moments.

Jimmy Anderson had, together with Steve Finn, bowled brilliantly without due reward on the third morning at the Gabba. It was payback time. With the following delivery he had Ricky Ponting caught, first ball, at second slip by Graeme Swann. Again, there was just enough swing to take the edge from the first ball of his second over. Swanny's safe hands swallowed up what remained of Michael Clarke's confidence.

That was the process of psychology in action. The scorecard in Brisbane refused to recognize Jimmy's excellence, but he gained inner strength from the small moral victories and narrow margins of supposed failure. He carried self-belief and a secret sense of security in the next game, when the theories played out spectacularly well.

To repeat that old line, trotted out by coaches since time immemorial: you can't win a Test match in the first hour, but you can certainly lose it. Michael Hussey and Brad Haddin helped Australia to 245 and left us with a single over to survive before the close. For some strange reason, the terms of engagement for that series had shifted, so that the final over had to be completed. Normally, if a wicket fell in that time, it was close of play. No offence, but I wasn't having the theory that Jimmy should go in as night watchman, in case of early calamity.

I said to Straussy, 'Fuck it. Let's front up.' He normally took first ball, but I offered to do so. He refused, after a bit of confusion. I was relieved, deep down, because I reasoned he wouldn't get off strike that evening. The first ball hit his thigh pad – *Wham!* – so we jogged a single. Instead of being a spectator from the other end, I had to grind through the final five deliveries. Flower's determination to put us under pressure in training had